Exploring Consumer Spending Habits

Problem Statement

SmartMart Retail Company operates across multiple regions and cities, selling a wide range of products to customers in different segments using various shipping modes and discount strategies. However, the company needs to better understand sales performance, customer purchasing behavior, product profitability, regional trends, and the impact of discounts and shipping methods on overall profit in order to improve decision-making and business growth.

You are a team of TechCrush data analysts at SmartMart, working with Aisha Musa, Head of Sales & Operations. Your insights will guide sales optimization and customer strategy improvements presented to the Chief Business Officer, Chinedu Okoli.

Dataset: https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/vivek468/superstore-dataset-final

Data Questions:

1. What are the total sales, total profit, and total quantity sold?
2. How do sales and profit trend over time (monthly and yearly)?
3. What products generate the highest revenue in each season?
4. Which customer segments spend the most?
5. How do discounts affect purchasing behavior?
6. Which product categories have the highest return rates?
7. Which periods record peak and lowest performance?
8. What are the top 10 products by sales and by profit?
9. Are there products with high sales but negative profit?
10. How much does each category contribute to total sales?
11. Which customers place the most frequent orders?
12. Which regions, states, and cities perform best in terms of sales and profit?
13. Are there regions with high sales but low or negative profit?
14. How do discounts affect profitability?
15. Which shipping modes are most used and most profitable?

Project Instructions

1. **Tools**: Students can use Excel, SQL, Power BI or PowerPoint to clean, analyze and visualize the data.

2. **Deliverables**:

- **Cleaned Datasets**: Submit cleaned versions of all datasets.
- **Analysis Report**: Answer the data questions with visualizations and insights.
- **Develop an interactive dashboard**
- **Presentation**: Prepare for a presentation summarizing key findings.
- **LinkedIn Post**: Share your project experience, including insights derived.